

Phonics Automaticity

Teacher Copy · Oral · ~5 min

SKILL 4/11

Student: _____

Grade: _____

Date: _____

Give real word first — immediately follow with a nonsense word, same pattern. Reveals memorizing vs. true decoding.

1 Real Word vs. Nonsense Word

Say: "Read this word... now read this silly made-up word. Just sound it out."

Real Word	✓ / ✗	Nonsense Word	✓ / ✗	Pattern
hop	✓ ✗	fop	✓ ✗	CVC
ship	✓ ✗	chib	✓ ✗	digraph
flag	✓ ✗	plag	✓ ✗	l-blend
cake	✓ ✗	vake	✓ ✗	magic-e
rain	✓ ✗	daip	✓ ✗	vowel team
bird	✓ ✗	sird	✓ ✗	r-controlled

Real word correct + nonsense word wrong = memorizing without decoding. Must address before advancing.

2 Timed Word Reading - 30 Seconds

Say: "Read as many words as you can. Go as fast as you can. Ready? Go."

cat	ship	flag	cake	rain	hop
chin	trip	bike	feet	farm	bird
stop	wish	blend	home	play	corn

Words correct in 30 sec: _____ Hesitated on: _____

Under 10 words / 30 sec = fluency concern. Drill current UFLI unit to automaticity before advancing.

Notes